

DYF 2026 Flag Rules

6 v 6 Flag Game Format

- Field is 30 yards wide and 53 yards long. The end zones are 5 yards long.
- Games are 6 players vs 6 players
- Regular Season Play - Two 20-minute running clock halves (*5-minute halftime*)
- Each possession starts at the 5 - yard line after scores, punts, start of the game and after halftime.
- 35 second play clock
- The offensive team has three downs to get a first down at mid-field, they can go for it on 4th down to cross mid-field for a first down or elect to "punt." Then 4 downs to score once they have crossed mid-field. If the offense elects to "punt" the ball will be awarded to the defense and they start their possession on the 5-yard line. If the offense fails to reach a first down or touchdown on a 4th down, the defense receives the ball at the spot.
- All players are eligible to receive a pass.
- NO RUSHING THE QUARTERBACK. Unless there is a handoff, a lateral, or backwards pass.
- Play clock will start and the offensive play can be run when the official is aligned with the spot of the ball and/or when the official blows their whistle
- After a timeout, the next play will start on the officials whistle.
- All players must play a minimum of 5 plays per half.
- No bull horns or train horns are allowed by fans in the stands because we have multiple games going on one field. If there is a horn blown in the stands, a warning will be given. After the warning, it will result in an unsportsmanlike conduct penalty against the team.

Scoring

- Touchdowns = 6 points
- Extra Point (5 yard line) = 1 pt (1st and 2nd grade, the no run zone applies)
- Extra Point (10 yard line) = 2 pts
- Safety = 2 pts

Game Play Flag Rules

Kindergarten Division Rules & Goals

- UNLIMITED Runs
- Coach Quarterback will count as the 6th player on offense.
- Coach QB can fake a handoff but the ball must be visible to the defense at all times. Coach QB must stay within a 1 yard by 1 yard "pocket" and cannot pump fake the defense. Coach QB cannot hide or shield a player behind him.
- 35 second play clock

- 5 second sack count
 - * Example 1 Mississippi, 2 Mississippi, 3 Mississippi, 4 Mississippi, SACK
- ONE Coach is allowed on the field for both offense and defense. Defensive coach must be behind the safeties out of the play before the snap.
- If a team is up by 16+ points, the winning team must sub in a Kid QB.
- No safeties allowed in Kinder. A safety will result in the next play at the 1 yard line for the offense.

1st & 2nd Grade Division Rules & Goals

- A “No Run Zone” applies if the ball is spotted at 5 yards or closer going into the endzone, including extra points.
- Kid Quarterback
- 35 second play clock
- 5 second sack count
 - **Update* Example 1 Mississippi, 2 Mississippi, 3 Mississippi, 4 Mississippi, SACK
- ONE Coach is allowed on the field for both offense and defense. Defensive coach must be behind the safeties out of the play before the snap.
- Kid QB can be Rushed by the defense if a fake handoff occurs. The Kid QB must try to throw the ball and cannot cross the LOS as a runner.
- Safeties result in 2 points for the defense and next possession of the ball.

Basic Rules

- Coin flip determines choice of possession or direction (winning team can elect to defer to the 2nd half)
- The clock will only stop for time-outs, injuries, and change of possession unless it is the last minute of the game. *The clock does not stop for incomplete passes, out of bounds.*
- **LAST 1 MINUTE OF THE GAME**
 1. The clock will stop in the final 1 minute of each half on these actions:
 - Incompletions
 - Out of Bounds
 - Change of Possession
 - Penalties. If it’s an offensive penalty the clock will start on the official unless dead ball foul.
- Two 30-second timeouts per half for each team
- If a timeout is called after a touchdown, the clock will not start until the play after the conversion attempt.
- Teams switch endzones at halftime.
- If there is a bad snap, the QB has a chance to field it.
- The Center cannot take a handoff from the QB.
- Ball is placed where the flag is pulled, **NOT** where the ball is when the flag is pulled.

- A receiver must have **one** foot in bounds when making a reception without any other body part out of bounds at the same time as the catch.
 - Laterals are allowed but if the ball hits the ground, the ball is spotted at that yard mark.
 - Fumbles will be spotted at the yard mark where the ball hits the ground.
 - No tackling, no picks, and no blocking.
 - Both flags must be on each player's hips prior to the start of every play, otherwise that player is ineligible. If a player's flags fall off during the middle of a play, the player must be "touched" down.
 - Only one player can be in motion at the same time.
 - 3 Players must be on the Line of Scrimmage or Illegal Formation; The Center counts as 1 player on the LOS.
 - Games cannot end on a defensive penalty. In the event, the down will be untimed and replayed after the penalty yardage is assessed.
- All grade Divisions will use a Pee-Wee size football.

Special Alert Rules

- Defensive players can cross the line of scrimmage when a handoff, fake handoff, or backward pass has occurred.
- Interceptions can be returned for a TD, if intercepting teams flag is pulled before the end zone then possession will begin where the defender is flagged. If the interception occurs in the end zone (and the flag is pulled in the end zone) the ball will be spotted on the 5 yard line

Pass Game Rules

- The Offense has to throw the ball within 5 Seconds
- *The sack count starts on the snap of the ball no matter what offensive play is attempted.*
- Forward pass can be underhand or overhand.
- The first person to touch the ball from the snap is deemed the QB.
- If the QB does not release the ball before time expires, the result of the play is a sack and the ball stays at the LOS.
- All grade levels have the option to throw a backward pass for a double pass play. This alerts the defense that they CAN cross the LOS to pull the flag of the player with the ball. The sack count does NOT reset when a lateral or backward pass is made, and the sack count is no longer in play. In 1st and 2nd Grade the QB is eligible. In Kinder, the Coach QB is not eligible.
- Defense must start 2 yds off the LOS unless the ball is at the +1 then the Defense can start at Goal line.

OFFENSE PENALTIES:

Offensive Pass Interference – 10 yard penalty and replay the down

Illegal motion (2 men in motion) – 5 yard penalty and replay the down

Illegal Formation – 5 yard penalty and replay the down

Illegal Run – 5 yard penalty and loss of down

False Start – 5 yard penalty, replay the down

Blocking – ball is placed at the spot of the foul and loss of down

Leaping – ball is placed at the spot of the foul and loss of down

Flag Guarding (including stiff arms) – 5 yard penalty from the spot of the foul and loss of down

Unsportsmanlike conduct – 15 yard penalty (*possible ejection*)

Delay of Game – clock is stopped and a 5 yard penalty.

- No Intentionally Grounding Penalty

DEFENSIVE PENALTIES:

Defensive Pass Interference - 10 yard penalty and replay down unless it's an offensive catch; Offense decides. *1st down can occur depending on the yardage.*

Illegal Contact (holding, jams, etc.) – 5 yard penalty and replay down unless it's an offensive catch; Offense decides. *1st can occur depending on the yardage.*

Defensive Holding while pulling flag – 5 yard penalty added to the end of the play and replay down. *1st down can occur depending on the yardage.*

Illegal Flag Pull (before player has ball) – 5 yard penalty and replay down. *1st down can occur depending on the yardage.*

Off-sides – 5 yard penalty and replay down. *1st down can occur depending on the yardage.*

Illegal Rushing (before a hand-off has occurred) – 5 yard penalty and replay the down; offense decides depending on the result of the play. *1st down can occur depending on the yardage.*

* **Update Inadvertent tackle** – 5 yard penalty added to the end of the play and replay down. *1st down can occur as a result of the penalty yardage*

Inadvertent tackle From Behind w/clear path to end zone – Automatic Touchdown

Unsportsmanlike conduct – 15 yard penalty and automatic 1st down (*possible ejection*)

Defensive Penalties inside the 10 yard line will result in half the distance to the Goal line if applicable.

OVERTIME FORMAT –Does not apply for Regular Season. Regular season can end in a Tie.

ONLY IN THE PLAYOFFS

- Overtime period will take place with each team receiving a possession.
- Coin flip determines choice of 1st or 2nd possession
- Possession begins at the 10 yard line (both teams will go in the same direction)
- If a touchdown is scored, a team can elect to go for a 1 or 2 point conversion.
- If the Defense intercepts the ball it's a change of possession starting at the 10 yard line unless the Defense returns it for a TD. Game could be over if the intercepting team was ahead in points in OT prior to playing Defense or intercepting team returns it for a TD on it's 1st Defensive possession per OT.
- If the game is still tied, overtime will be repeated until there is a winner.
- Offensive team will get 2 downs to score from the +10 yard line
- Teams alternate first possession each overtime period

Standings Tiebreaker

For seeding purposes in the playoffs, below will be followed:

1. Overall Record
2. Head-to-Head
3. Points Against
4. Points Scored
5. Point Differential
6. Coin Flip